The Alleged Incident

State of Maharashtra v Arjun Mehta | Fictional case record

Case Record | Not a Judgment

Hypothetical State of Maharashtra v Arjun Mehta. Fictional forum: Judicial Magistrate First Class, Pune. Exercise ID: DEMO-THEFT-2023. No real case number, filed charge, hearing, or judicial finding is represented.

All persons, businesses, records, quotations and events below are invented for this exercise. Any resemblance is coincidental. This is a source packet for adversarial analysis, not an outcome or an authentic police/court record.

01 | Facts and Allegations

The scenario concerns an alleged shop theft on 15 March 2023 at the fictional Nira Mobile Corner, Pune. Shopkeeper Kavya Rao alleges that a display phone worth INR 18,500 disappeared during an evening visit by Arjun Mehta [E1]. Ownership, value, taking and identity remain unproved.

Arjun denies taking any phone and claims he attended an evening training session at fictional Westbridge Skills Centre [E4]. No phone is recorded as recovered in the supplied exercise inventory [E7]. That inventory does not establish what occurred outside this packet.

Record facts are limited: E1-E7 are the supplied fictional materials; they contain conflicting accounts. A statement's inclusion is not proof that its contents are true. No witness credibility has been determined.

02 | Timeline / All Times Local (IST)

15 March, 17:55 - [E4] lists a handwritten sign-in beside Arjun's name. There is no sign-out entry or continuous-presence record.

18:08-18:12 - [E2] clip overlay shows a customer near the shop counter. Clock accuracy is unknown; overlay time is not established actual time.

About 18:10 - [E1] alleges a phone was taken. [E3] places a similar-looking person outside around 18:20; [E5] instead describes departure before 18:00.

18:25 - [E4] instructor note records a roll call but not each person's arrival/departure. Travel time between shop and centre is not supplied.

16 March - [E6] says an officer received a USB copy from the shopkeeper. 18 March - [E7] lists no recovered handset. These are packet dates only.

Reading Key

[E1]-[E7] are stable source references used throughout. Quotation marks identify invented excerpts from this packet, not real testimony or law. Use the exhibit and its limitations together when making an argument.

Evidence Register

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03 | Evidence / Fictional Excerpts

The excerpts below are the complete evidence supplied for the exercise. There are no attached originals, actual video files, sworn depositions, or authenticated records. Do not infer that an omitted document exists.

[E1] Shopkeeper Complaint Summary | 15 March 2023

Kavya Rao: "At about 6:10 pm I saw Arjun put the display phone into his bag. I turned to the cash drawer and he was gone. I had not sold it." Limitation: allegation only; no stock ledger, receipt, device identifier or account of uninterrupted observation is supplied.

[E2] CCTV Viewing Note | Clip Overlay 18:08-18:12

Unsigned note: "A person in a dark jacket reaches toward the display. The face is partly obscured. The object in the hand cannot be resolved." Limitation: this describes a clip, not an identification result. No original recording, full sequence or verified clock offset is supplied.

[E3] Nearby Vendor Statement | 16 March 2023

Fictional vendor Dev Shah: "I think it was Arjun outside at about 6:20. I recognised the jacket, but I did not see anyone take a phone." Limitation: uncertain identity, approximate time and no direct account of a taking; prior familiarity and viewing conditions are undocumented.

[E4] Attendance Sheet and Instructor Note | 15 March 2023

Sheet: "Arjun Mehta - 17:55" (handwritten). Fictional instructor Mira Sen: "His name was marked present at the 18:25 roll call. I cannot say he stayed in the room throughout." Limitation: authorship of sign-in, method of roll call and original sheet are unverified; no exit log.

[E5] Shop Assistant Statement | 17 March 2023

Fictional assistant Rohan Kale: "The customer in the dark jacket left before 6 pm. I noticed the empty stand after 6:15. I did not see a taking." Limitation: this conflicts with E1’s timing and direct-observation claim. Whether both describe the same customer or phone is unresolved.

[E6] USB Receipt Note | 16 March 2023

Fictional officer Neel Patil: "Received one unsealed USB from Kavya Rao; she said a technician copied the clip." Limitation: technician unnamed; no hash, export log, seal record, device seizure, original storage preservation or subsequent transfer log is supplied.

[E7] Exercise Property Inventory | 18 March 2023

Entry: "One USB copy listed. No handset recovered in the materials recorded here." Limitation: not a certified search record. There is no supplied recovery, forensic device match, sale trail or admission linking Arjun to the alleged missing phone.

Questions for the Courtroom

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04 | Prosecution Position / To Be Tested

The prosecution may argue that E1's claimed observation, the reaching gesture in E2 and the tentative sighting in E3 support its theory of identity and a taking without permission. It may argue that E4 leaves a gap in continuous attendance. These are submissions, not findings.

Address why E1 and E5 disagree, whether the E2 figure can be identified, and how E6's provenance gaps affect reliance on the clip. Do not call E3 an eyewitness to theft or treat an attendance gap as proof of guilt.

05 | Defense Position / To Be Tested

The defense may rely on E4 as an alibi lead, E2's obscured face, E3's uncertainty, E5's conflicting account, and the absence of a recorded handset recovery in E7. It disputes identity and the alleged taking.

Address E1's direct allegation rather than ignoring it. E4 does not prove continuous presence; E7 does not itself disprove a taking. No travel-time calculation or inference of fabricated testimony is justified on this packet alone.

06 | Disputed Legal Issues / Research, Do Not Assume

Contextual labels only: IPC section 378 (theft) and section 379 (punishment for theft). Their mention is not a legal determination that any ingredient, charge or liability is established. No statute is quoted.

The alleged incident is 15 March 2023, before the BNS commencement. Check temporal applicability, commencement and savings provisions using authoritative sources; do not mechanically substitute BNS labels. Also verify the applicable procedural and electronic-evidence framework.

Identify what must be proved about the property, possession, consent, intent and alleged movement; assess identity, alibi and competing timelines. Separate admissibility/authentication questions about E2/E6 from evidential weight. This packet supplies no precedents.

07 | Missing Information / Priority Requests

Seek original CCTV and surrounding footage, clock calibration, export details, hashes and custody records [E2, E6]; inventory/ownership records and phone identifiers [E1, E7]; original attendance, author and roll-call method, location and travel evidence [E4]; clarified witness timelines, sightlines, prior familiarity and customer identity [E1, E3, E5].

08 | Request to Agents / Deliverables

Prosecution and defense: give your strongest source-cited arguments and one concession each. Rebut the opposing reading without inventing evidence. Cite [E1]-[E7] and distinguish quotation, allegation, inference and verified legal proposition. Mark unknowns explicitly.

Judicial analyst: map agreement and disputes, explain how missing information could alter analysis, and list targeted follow-up questions. Verify law before citing it; if research is unavailable, say so. Produce a provisional issue assessment only, not a verdict or sentence.